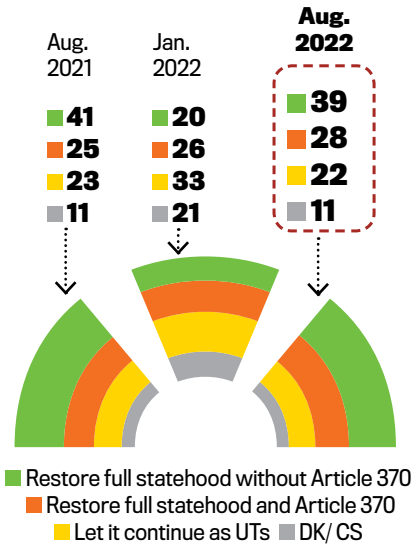
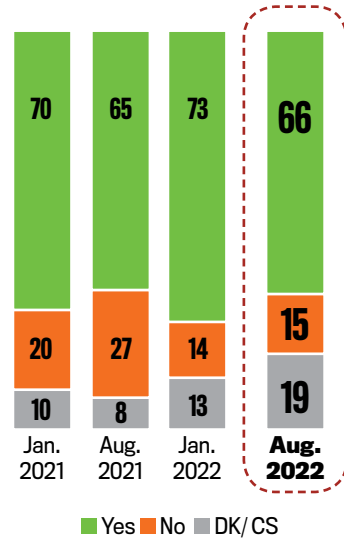
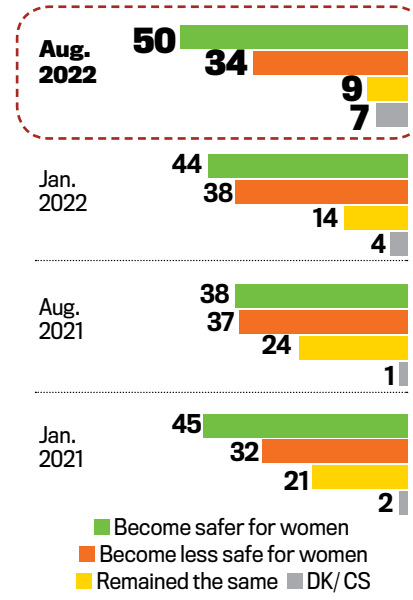
Q. What should the Union government do to restore 'normalcy' to Jammu & Kashmir?



Q. Should India implement a uniform civil code?



Q. Has India become safer or less safe for women?

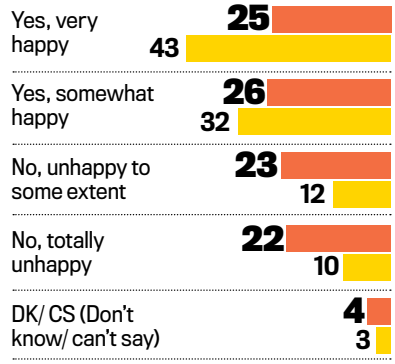


(All figures in percentage; DK/ CS: Don't know/ can't say)

When it comes to their take on socio-cultural issues, there seems to be a conflict between the liberal and the traditional sides. While a clear-cut 63 per cent believe celebrities posing semi-nude or nude is 'obscene', opinion is divided on whether India should legalise cannabis. The support for a uniform civil code has fallen to 65.8 per cent from 72.7 per cent in January 2022. Almost three years after Article 370 was abrogated and the erstwhile state of Jammu & Kashmir bifurcated into Union territories, unrest and uncertainties continue to plague the region. While 28 per cent of the MOTN respondents believe that Article 370 should be reinstated, 39.4 per cent are opposed to the idea. A majority (67 per cent) believe that the way to normalcy is through restoring full statehood to J&K.

On women's safety, MOTN reflects an all-time high—almost half believe India has become safer for women, while 34 per cent feel it is less safe than before and 9 per cent say nothing has changed. This could be an outcome of the several measures taken by central and state governments in the past one year. Technology has helped law enforcers come up with faster, more accessible and anonymous ways for women to reach out for assistance. Some states like Andhra Pradesh have apps that enable users to send out distress alerts to the police by simply shaking the phone. The Centre's 112 app also sends such notifications along with audio or visual proof and even tracks the progress of an incident through video. Other achievements include over 700 one-stop centres for women's psycho-social wellbeing, a special railway protection force for them and a pan-India emergency response telephone line.

Q. Do you consider yourself happy?



(All figures in percentage)

The country as a whole has faced many tough challenges in the past one year. Estimates in a 2021 *Lancet* study showed that cases of depression, sadness and anxiety had risen by 35 per cent in India over a year. Not only have there been growing economic uncertainties as well as exposure to images and stories of war, but the pandemic too has shown no clear sign of getting over. All these seem to have taken a toll, with only 51 per cent of the respondents saying they are very happy or somewhat happy, down from 75 per cent in January 2022. ■